50 **From the labs**
We take a look at Elon Musk's dream of fast mass transportation – the Hyperloop

More earth-like planets
Data from NASA's Kepler mission suggests that nearby red dwarfs just 13 lightyears away, could have life much older than our own.

NASA's Ambitious Expeditions into the SOLAR SYSTEM

We give you the low down on the missions NASA has planned over the next 30 years

Not the movie, this is probably named after Jupiter's wife

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National Aeronautics and Space Administration, or more commonly known as NASA is one of the most premiere Space Agencies in the world. It was formed on July 28th 1958 under the watch of the then President of the United States Dwight D. Eisenhower, who stated that the purpose of the agency was to engage in peaceful space exploration (civilian rather than military).

The agency just passed the 55 year mark of being in existence, and in those long years it has accomplished many successes, starting with putting the first satellite into space, to putting a man on the moon and not to mention The Hubble Space Telescope, which in itself has led to some incredible advances in our understanding of not just our galaxy, but the universe as a whole. It even launched the most sensitive telescope in the world, the Chandra X-Ray Observatory, which relies on X-Rays instead of visible light to create images and observe the happenings of the universe. The Chandra X-Ray Observatory has even captured particles right before they disappeared into the abyss that is a black hole.

NASA's come an incredibly long way in not just expanding our knowledge of the universe, but also in racking up its achievements. They've put man-made instruments of measurement on alien planets, photographed dying stars and colliding galaxies and not to mention, developed a reusable shuttle that can perform repeated missions. Let's not forget the fact that NASA played a key role in transporting components of the International Space Station into space. However, as amazing these achievements may have been, NASA has several programs in place that will be coming to fruition over the next two decades or so, which focus a lot on exploring and understanding our neighbouring entities. For your reading pleasure, here are some of the really exciting ones:

Lunar Atmosphere and Dust Environment Explorer (LADEE): September 2013

The LADEE program will collect and analyse samples of any lunar dust particles in the tenuous atmosphere. These measurements will help scientists address a longstanding mystery: was lunar dust electrically charged by solar ultraviolet light, responsible for the pre-sunrise horizon glow that the Apollo astronauts saw. The instruments on board are a UV and Visible Light spectrometer that will determine the composition of Lunar Dust by analysing the